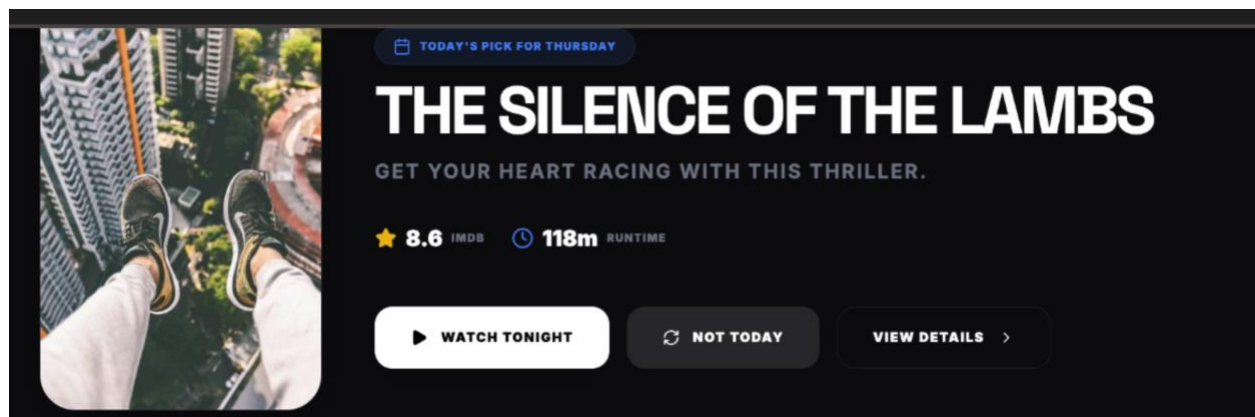


PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

CineTrack

Your Cinema, Your Rules.

CineTrack is a cinematic journaling system designed to make movie-watching feel reflective, immersive, and worth returning to.



Product Name	CineTrack
Author / PM	Arunjyoti Kalita
Version	v1.0 — Initial Release
Status	Live — aura-cinetrack.vercel.app
Last Updated	May 2026
Document Type	Full Product PRD

0. Why This Product Mattered Personally

I have always been a serious film watcher — someone who thinks about what they watch, not just what to watch next. But every tool I tried felt wrong. Letterboxd was too social. IMDb was a database. Notion was a blank canvas that required more work than the film deserved.

I wanted something that matched how I experience cinema — reflective, personal, and visually worthy of the medium. CineTrack started as a personal fix and became a full product design exercise in building for users who care deeply about the experience, not just the list.

1. Executive Summary

CineTrack is a personal cinematic journal and analytics platform that solves a core problem for dedicated film enthusiasts: existing tools are either too social (Letterboxd), too bare (IMDb), or too manual (Notion) to deliver a meaningful, immersive logging experience.

CineTrack combines quick-entry logging, deep metadata tracking, geographical cinema analytics, mood-based discovery, taste evolution visualisation, and a multi-layer progression system — all wrapped in a cinematic dark-mode UI designed to feel as premium as the films it tracks.

Built through rapid AI-assisted iteration, shaped by real-world feedback from movie-enthusiast users from day one.

Product Principles

- Logging should feel lighter than remembering to log later
- Reflection matters more than collection
- Progression should feel intrinsic, not manipulative
- Discovery should begin with emotional intent, not algorithmic complexity
- AI should reduce friction and improve relevance — not overwhelm the experience

2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Core Problem

Dedicated film enthusiasts lack a single tool that treats movie-watching as an aesthetic, emotional, and analytical experience worth documenting. The current landscape forces users to choose between social validation, raw data lookup, or manual organisation — none of which serve the core need of meaningful personal reflection.

2.2 Specific Pain Points

#	Pain Point	Current Workaround	Impact
1	Log fatigue — opening a full form to record a simple watch feels like work	Users skip or batch-log later with less accuracy	High — directly reduces logging consistency
2	Surface-level insights — "you watched 47 movies" is not actionable	Manual spreadsheet tracking	High — no reason to return beyond logging
3	No emotional layer — nowhere to record how a film made you feel	Separate notes apps, outside the tracker	Medium — breaks the single-app experience
4	No geographical awareness — users don't know how narrow their viewing is	No workaround exists	Medium — missed product insight opportunity
5	No reason to build a habit — no streaks, milestones, or progress	External habit-tracking apps	High — drives churn after first 2–3 weeks
6	Decision fatigue — "what should I watch tonight?" has no good answer	Scroll streaming platforms for 30 minutes	High — daily friction point
7	Data lock-in — history stuck in Letterboxd or IMDb	Manual re-entry, rarely completed	Medium — acquisition blocker for power users

3. Goals & Success Metrics

3.1 Product Goals

- Reduce log friction to the point where logging feels easier than not logging
- Deliver insights that make users say "I didn't know that about myself" — not just counts
- Create return triggers that bring users back daily, weekly, and monthly
- Establish a clear point of difference from Letterboxd and IMDb that cannot be easily replicated

3.2 North Star Metric

North Star: "Journaling Depth" — the ratio of entries with a personal review, quote, or mood tag vs. total entries logged. A user who journals is engaged. A user who only rates is at risk of churn.

3.3 Supporting Metrics

Metric	Definition	Target	Why It Matters
Day-30 Retention	% of users active 30 days after first log	> 40%	Primary indicator of habit formation
Journaling Depth	% of entries with review, quote, or mood tag	> 50%	North Star — measures true engagement depth

Metric	Definition	Target	Why It Matters
Countries Covered	Avg unique countries logged per user per quarter	> 5 countries	World Cinema Map engagement signal
Challenge Completion	% of users completing the 30-Day Challenge	> 25%	Measures progression effectiveness
Arena Participation	% of active users in a Weekly Arena challenge	> 30%	Measures competitive return signal
Quick Log Usage	% of entries created via Quick Log FAB vs full form	> 40%	Validates friction-reduction strategy

4. Target Users

4.1 Primary — The Pro-Cinephile

Who	Film students, hobbyist critics, and dedicated enthusiasts watching 100+ titles/year
Motivations	Wants to understand their own taste, discover blind spots, track directors they love, and have a beautiful record of their cinematic journey
Frustrations	Letterboxd is shallow. IMDb has no personal layer. Spreadsheets are ugly and manual. No tool treats them as a curator, not just a consumer
Key Features	World Cinema Map, Taste Evolution, Director Profile, My Cinema Diary, deep metadata schema (nano-genres, awards, lead actors)

4.2 Secondary — The List-Maker

Who	Organised, goal-oriented users who enjoy collecting, curating, and completing personal challenges
Motivations	Wants to finish a director's filmography, complete a 30-day challenge, earn trophies, and share achievements
Frustrations	No existing tool gamifies movie watching in a meaningful, non-trivial way
Key Features	30-Day Challenge, Trophy Shelf, Weekly Arena, Custom Lists, Watchlist, Cinematic Wrapped

5. Feature Specifications

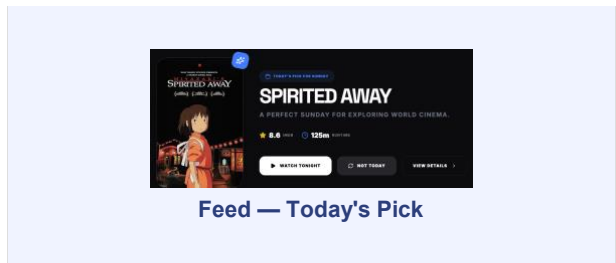
Features are grouped by product goal. Every feature reinforces at least one of three objectives: reduce logging friction, deepen reflection, or create a return trigger that sustains long-term use.

Hero features — World Cinema Map, Taste Evolution, and Quick Log FAB — are the product's signature experiences. Everything else is built to support or complement them.

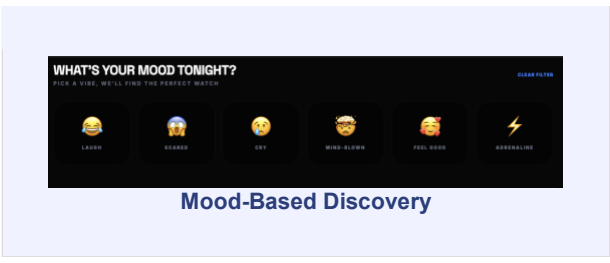
5.1 Discovery & Decision Reduction

Feed & Today's Pick

User Story	As a user, I want a curated movie recommendation every day so I don't have to decide what to watch from scratch
Acceptance Criteria	Daily pick shown with title, IMDb rating, runtime, genre tag, and Watch Tonight / Not Today CTAs. "Not Today" surfaces a new suggestion. Pick refreshes daily. Live stats (total titles, watched count, avg rating) shown below the hero.
Design Decision	Today's Pick is the first element a user sees on login — it solves decision fatigue before the user even has to think about it. The hero placement is intentional: reduce the time between opening the app and deciding what to watch.



Daily pick hero card with Watch Tonight / Not Today CTAs and live stats



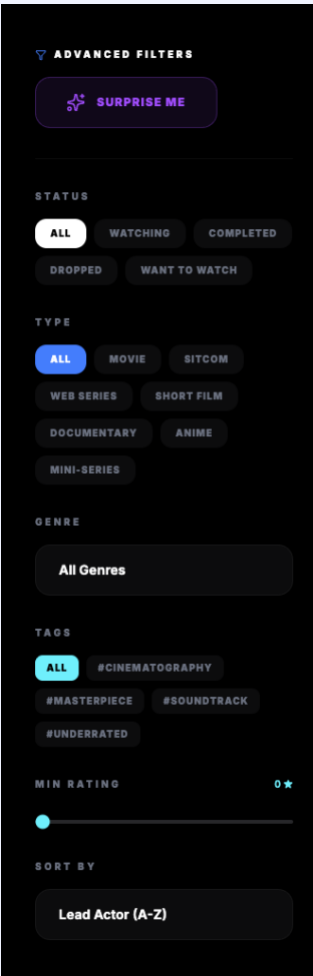
6 mood tiles — Laugh, Scared, Cry, Mind-Blown, Feel Good, Adrenaline

Mood-Based Discovery

User Story	As a user, I want to filter my watchlist by how I'm feeling tonight so I find something that actually fits my mood
Acceptance Criteria	6 mood options on Feed: Laugh, Scared, Cry, Mind-Blown, Feel Good, Adrenaline. Selecting a mood filters the watchlist and suggestions in real time. Moods can be combined.
Design Decision	Mood filter chosen over AI recommendations for v1 — faster to build, emotionally intuitive, and requires no training data. The emotional framing (not genre framing) is deliberate: users know how they feel, not always which genre they want.

Advanced Filters & Surprise Me

User Story	As a user, I want to slice my library across multiple dimensions so I can find exactly what I'm looking for
Acceptance Criteria	Filter panel with: Status, Type (Movie/Series/Documentary/Anime/Mini-Series), Genre, Tags (#Cinematography, #Masterpiece, #Soundtrack, #Underrated), Min Rating slider, Sort By. Surprise Me picks a random entry matching active filters.
Design Decision	Tags go beyond fixed genre labels — they let users apply personal classification (e.g. #Underrated) that standard systems don't capture. Surprise Me directly addresses paralysis on a long-filtered list.



Advanced Filters Panel

Status, Type, Genre, Tags, Min Rating, and Surprise Me

5.2 Logging & Entry

★ Quick Log FAB — Hero Feature

User Story	As a user, I want to log a movie in under 10 seconds so that the effort of logging never exceeds the value of logging
Acceptance Criteria	FAB visible on all screens (bottom right). Tap opens a minimal overlay: title field with instant autocomplete, star rating. One tap to save. Full metadata can be added from the entry later.
Design Decision	Quick Log defers deep journaling by design — capture the watch event first. The floating position ensures it's reachable without interrupting any current view. Outcome: reduced friction between finishing a film and logging it, noticeably improving logging consistency.

Quick Log FAB — Fast Entry Overlay

Full Entry Form — Rich Metadata

Title autocompletes with instant suggestions and star rating 30+ fields including nano-genres, mood emoji, review, and rating

Full Entry Form

User Story	As a user, I want to record rich details about a film so that my journal reflects my true experience of it
Acceptance Criteria	30+ metadata fields: title, director, year, runtime, language, country, platform, personal rating (1–10), IMDb rating, nano-genres (e.g. Neo-Noir, Slow Cinema), lead actor/actress, awards, mood emoji, watched date, personal review, memorable quotes, recommendation tag.
Design Decision	Nano-genres capture the specific texture of a film beyond standard labels — enabling richer taste analytics downstream. The recommendation tag is a deliberate simplification: it captures the most shareable sentiment without requiring nuanced ratings.

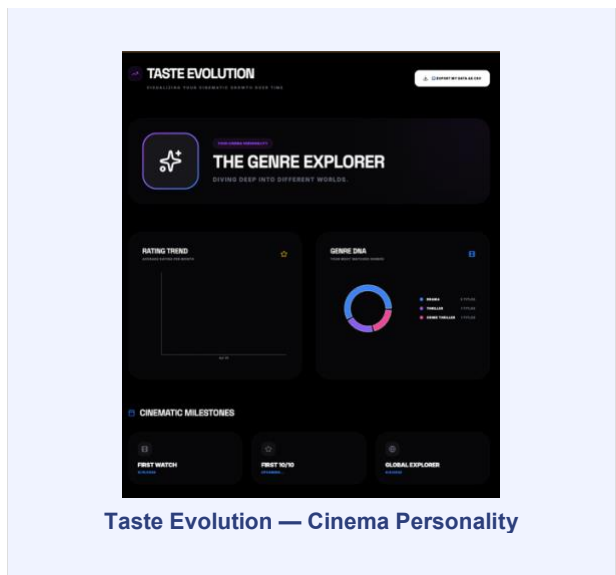
CSV Import / Export

User Story	As a user migrating from Letterboxd or IMDb, I want to import my full watch history without losing years of data
Acceptance Criteria	CSV import with custom parser mapping Letterboxd and IMDb column formats automatically. Date normalisation handled. Full data exportable as CSV at any time from Profile. Recover Posters utility for restoring missing artwork from imported entries.
Design Decision	Data portability is an acquisition strategy — removing the migration barrier converts power users from competing platforms. Export is equally critical: users should never feel locked in.

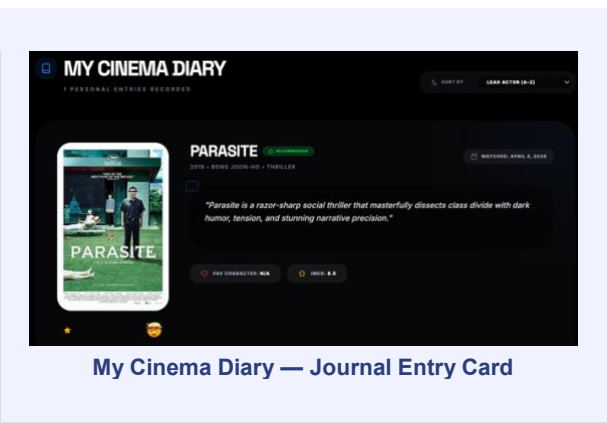
5.3 Analytics & Insight

☆ Taste Evolution — Hero Feature

User Story	As a user, I want to see how my taste in movies has changed over time so I can understand myself as a viewer
Acceptance Criteria	Cinema Personality label derived from watch history (e.g. "The Genre Explorer — Diving Deep Into Different Worlds"). Rating Trend chart: average rating per month as an area chart. Genre DNA donut chart: most-watched genres with title counts. Export data as CSV.
Design Decision	The Cinema Personality label is a deliberate identity feature — it gives users a named archetype for their taste, creating an emotional anchor to the product. Users share their personality label the way they share Spotify Wrapped results.



Personality label, Rating Trend area chart, and Genre DNA donut

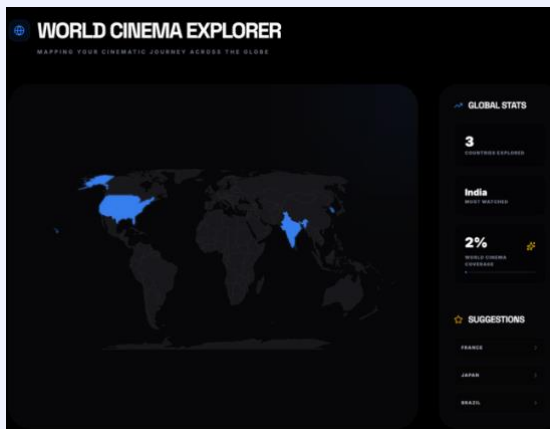


My Cinema Diary — Journal Entry Card

Parasite entry with review, director, mood emoji, and recommendation badge

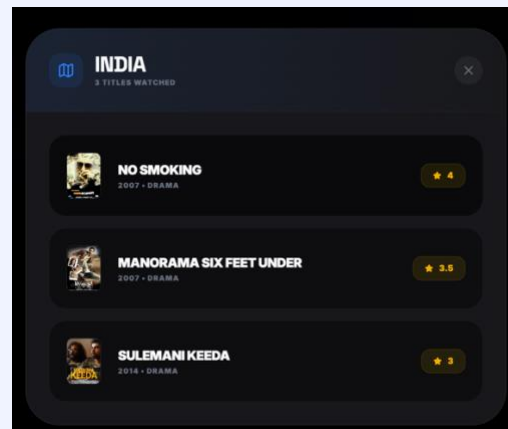
☆ World Cinema Map — Hero Feature

User Story	As a user, I want to see which countries' films I've watched so I can understand the geographical range of my viewing and be nudged to explore further
Acceptance Criteria	Interactive world map using Equal Earth Projection. Watched countries highlighted. Hover shows country name and watch count. Click opens drill-down modal: all titles watched from that country with year, genre, and personal rating. Global Stats sidebar: countries explored, most-watched country, % world coverage. Suggestions panel: 3 recommended unexplored countries.
Design Decision	Equal Earth Projection chosen for accurate relative country size — important for a feature centred on geographical fairness. The Suggestions panel turns a passive visualisation into an active discovery prompt.
Origin Insight	Conceived at an airport — a physical passport stamps countries visited; CineTrack stamps the countries cinematically explored. The metaphor defines the entire feature and sets the product apart from every competing tracker.
Outcome	Users explored more international cinema after encountering the map. The "cinematic passport" framing created an immediate emotional connection that other features couldn't replicate.



World Cinema Map — Global View

Lit-up countries, Global Stats sidebar, and Suggestions panel



Country Drill-Down Modal

Titles watched from that country with year, genre, and rating

My Cinema Diary (Journal)

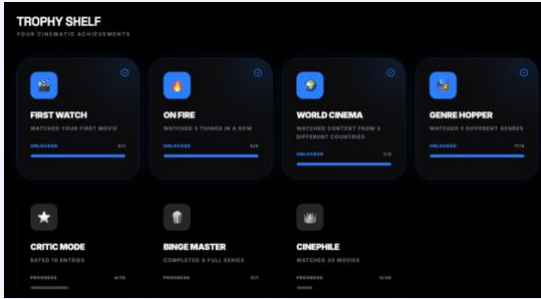
User Story	As a user, I want a beautiful journal view of everything I've watched so my history feels like a personal archive, not a spreadsheet
Acceptance Criteria	Card view: poster, title, director, year, genre, watched date, review quote, favourite character, IMDb badge, personal stars, mood emoji, recommendation badge. Sortable by date, rating, title, lead actor.
Design Decision	The journal card is designed to be screenshot-worthy — rich enough to share, minimal enough to scan. The recommendation badge is visible at a glance without opening the entry.

5.4 Progression & Retention

Three interconnected layers designed to drive return visits at different time horizons: daily (30-Day Challenge), weekly (Weekly Arena), and long-term (Trophy Shelf). Progression challenges increased re-engagement conversations more than any other feature in v1.

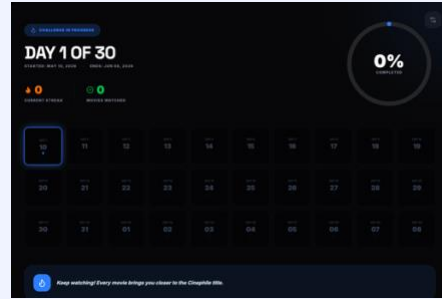
Trophy Shelf

User Story	As a user, I want to earn recognition for my watching milestones so there is a sense of meaningful progress beyond just adding to a list
Acceptance Criteria	7 trophies with progress bars: First Watch, On Fire (5 in a row), World Cinema (3 countries), Genre Hopper (5 genres), Critic Mode (10 rated entries), Binge Master (full series), Cinephile (30 movies). Locked trophies show current progress vs. target.
Design Decision	Progress bars on locked trophies are critical — they tell users how close they are, which is far more motivating than a locked icon with no context. Each trophy reinforces a specific core behaviour: logging, journaling, exploring, or completing.



Trophy Shelf — Profile Page

Unlocked trophies and locked ones with progress bars



30-Day Challenge — Calendar Sprint

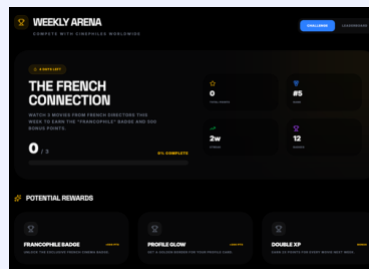
Day X of 30, streak counter, and circular progress ring

30-Day Challenge

User Story	As a user, I want a structured 30-day challenge to build a consistent watching habit and work toward the Cinephile trophy
Acceptance Criteria	30-day calendar grid from chosen start date. Streak counter with 🧑 icon. Movies watched counter. Circular progress ring (0–100%). Contextual motivational message referencing the Cinephile trophy. Confetti animation on 100% completion.
Design Decision	The motivational message directly references the Trophy Shelf — it connects the daily challenge to the larger achievement system, reinforcing both simultaneously. The calendar grid gives a spatial sense of progress that a single percentage cannot.

Weekly Arena

User Story	As a user, I want to compete in weekly themed challenges so I discover films I would never have found on my own
Acceptance Criteria	New themed challenge weekly (e.g. "The French Connection" — watch 3 French director films). Progress tracker with %. Stats: total points, global rank, streak, badges. Potential Rewards: exclusive badge (+500pts), cosmetic (Profile Glow), multiplier (Double XP next week). Global leaderboard. 4-day countdown.
Design Decision	Weekly themes are cinema education by stealth — the challenge teaches users about French cinema while they think they are competing for points. Double XP is a forward-looking mechanic: it gives users a reason to engage with next week's challenge before it starts.



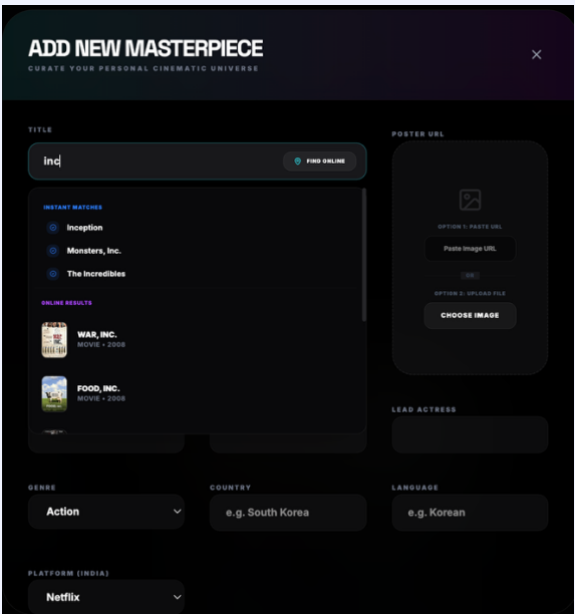
Weekly Arena — Themed Challenge

The French Connection challenge, progress, stats, and Potential Rewards

5.5 Search Engine

CineTrack uses a two-layer search system: a local Prefix Index for zero-latency autocomplete, and fuzzy matching for typo tolerance. Together they ensure logging never feels interrupted by a search failure.

Instant Autocomplete	Prefix Index maps typed characters to matches instantly. Seeded with 150 popular titles for a strong cold-start experience. User's personal library indexed in real time — suggestions include already-added titles to prevent duplicates.
Typo-Tolerant Search	Edit-distance algorithm ensures correct results for single-character typos (e.g. "Inception" → "Inception"). Applied to both local library and OMDb API results.
Unified Dropdown	Segmented by source: Instant Matches (local + popular, zero latency) and Online Results (OMDb, ranked by similarity). Same engine powers both Quick Log FAB and the full Add Movie form.



Search — Unified Dropdown

Instant Matches and Online Results sections with autocomplete

5.6 Profile & Cinematic Wrapped

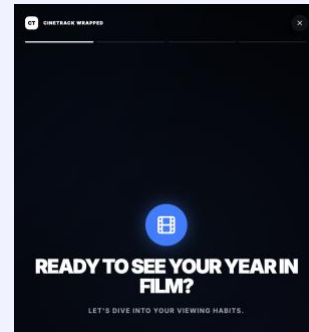
Profile Page

User Story	As a user, I want a home for my identity within CineTrack — my stats, achievements, and data controls
Acceptance Criteria	Displays: name, email, avatar. Stats: Watched, Watchlist, Favourites. Actions: View Wrapped, Recover Posters, Import CSV, Export CSV, Clear All Data, Sign Out. Trophy Shelf below stats.
Design Decision	All data controls are placed on the Profile page — this is the user's settings area without being labelled as settings. Maintains the cinematic theme throughout the rest of the navigation.



Profile Page — Stats & Trophy Shelf

Stats, action buttons, and full Trophy Shelf with all 7 trophies



Cinematic Wrapped — Year in Film

Shareable infographic summary of the user's cinematic year

Cinematic Wrapped

User Story	As a user, I want a shareable summary of my year in film so I can celebrate my cinematic journey
Acceptance Criteria	Infographic modal from Profile → View Wrapped. Summarises: total titles, top genres, most-watched director, top-rated film, countries explored, total watch time. Designed to be screenshot-shareable.
Design Decision	Wrapped is the product's growth mechanism — a shareable visual that brings CineTrack to new audiences. The design must be visually distinctive enough to be recognisable when shared, the way Spotify Wrapped is immediately identifiable.

6. Technical Requirements

6.1 Core Tech Stack

Technology	Layer	Purpose
React 19	Frontend Framework	Component-based UI with concurrent rendering
Vite 6	Build Tool	Fast dev server and production bundler
TypeScript	Language	Type safety for the complex 30+ field Entry interface
Tailwind CSS v4	Styling	Zero-runtime CSS — 60FPS performance on data-heavy views
Framer Motion	Animation	Cinematic page transitions and modal animations
Firebase Firestore	Database	Cloud document store — document-per-user model
Recharts	Data Viz	Taste Evolution area charts and Genre DNA donut charts
D3-geo + TopoJSON	Cartography	World Cinema Map — Equal Earth Projection
Vercel	Deployment	Automatic CI/CD on push — zero config deployment

aura-cinetrack.vercel.app

6.2 Data Architecture

Primary Storage	Firebase Firestore — document-per-user model. Atomic updates prevent overwriting sibling arrays on partial saves.
Fallback Storage	LocalStorage — active when Firestore is unavailable. <code>userStorage.ts</code> bridges both layers, prioritising cloud data at all times.
Migration Bridge	On login: attempts Firestore load → falls back to LocalStorage → migrates legacy local data to cloud. Zero data loss for returning users.
Local Dev	Express + JSON Server — available for self-hosted or offline development environments.

6.3 Key Architectural Decisions

Custom Event Bus	<code>cinetrack_genre_change</code> event decouples <code>MoodMusicPlayer</code> from React's render cycle. Genre filter changes auto-switch ambient audio with zero re-renders — clean separation of UI and audio layers.
Prefix Index + Fuzzy Search	In-memory index rebuilt on library update, seeded with 150 popular titles. Edit-distance algorithm provides typo tolerance across both local library and OMDb results.
Equal Earth Projection	Chosen for the World Cinema Map for accurate relative country size representation — important for a feature centred on geographical awareness and fairness across all regions.
Performance Budget	60FPS target across all interactions. Achieved via Tailwind v4 zero-runtime styling and lazy loading for D3 map and Recharts components.

7. Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Specification	Priority
Performance	All interactions target 60FPS. Initial load under 3 seconds on standard broadband.	Must-have
Responsiveness	Full functionality on desktop (1280px+). Core logging functional on tablet (768px+).	Must-have
Data Persistence	All entries synced to Firestore within 2 seconds of save. LocalStorage fallback prevents data loss.	Must-have
Authentication	Google OAuth via Firebase Auth. Session persistence across browser restarts.	Must-have
Data Portability	Full CSV export available at any time. Import from Letterboxd and IMDb formats supported.	Must-have
Offline Mode	Core logging available offline via LocalStorage. Cloud sync on reconnection.	Should-have
Accessibility	Sufficient colour contrast in dark mode. Keyboard navigation for core logging and search.	Should-have
Browser Support	Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge — latest 2 major versions.	Must-have

8. Out of Scope — v1

The following features were consciously deferred to maintain focus and shipping velocity:

Feature	Reason Deferred	Roadmap Status
AI Recommendations	Deferred until sufficient viewing signal exists. Mood filter serves this need for now.	v2 — after Taste Evolution data matures
OMDb Auto-fill	Highest v2 priority — eliminates manual metadata entry, the single biggest remaining friction point.	v2 — first shipping priority
Mobile Native App	Web-first approach validates core product value before investing in native development.	v3 — pending web validation
Social Features	CineTrack is intentionally private-first. Social layer adds complexity before core value is proven.	Evaluate post product-market fit
Streaming Availability	"Where to watch" data requires a paid API. Deferred until monetisation is in place.	v2 with Pro tier

9. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Log fatigue / manual entry	High	High	Quick Log FAB and CSV Import reduce entry friction. OMDb auto-fill is the primary v2 priority.
World Cinema Map on mobile	Medium	Medium	Map optimised for desktop. Mobile shows a simplified country list view. Full map deferred to native app phase.
Firebase cost scaling	Low	Medium	Free tier covers ~50,000 reads/day. Cost monitoring alerts active. Pro tier planned before scaling beyond free tier.
Arena content staleness	Medium	Medium	Themes pre-planned 4 weeks ahead. User-submitted challenge ideas as a future mechanism.
OMDb API rate limits	Low	Low	Prefix Index handles the majority of searches locally. OMDb only called when local results are insufficient.

10. Roadmap

Phase	Feature / Initiative	Rationale
v1 — Shipped	Full logging system, Quick Log FAB, Advanced Filters, Mood Discovery, Taste Evolution, World Cinema Map, Weekly Arena, 30-Day Challenge, Trophy Shelf, CSV Import/Export, Cinematic Wrapped, Custom Search Engine	Core product loop validated with real users
v2 — Next	TMDB/OMDb API auto-fill for director, year, country, runtime	Eliminates the #1 remaining friction point — manual metadata entry

Phase	Feature / Initiative	Rationale
v2 — Next	AI Mood-Based Recommendations — Taste Evolution + current mood	Natural evolution of the Mood filter once sufficient data exists
v2 — Next	Director Streak Challenge — progress bar to complete a filmography	Turns Director Profile from a passive view into an active challenge
v2 — Next	Cinematic Wrapped PDF Export	Expands the growth and referral loop beyond in-app screenshots
v3 — Future	Mobile native app (iOS / Android)	After web product-market fit is confirmed
v3 — Future	Deeper Series & Anime episodic tracking	Dedicated experience for episodic content
Evaluate	Social features, following, collaborative watchlists	Only after core private journaling value is fully validated

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